

DTU Video Transcript

The director of our Discrimination Testing Unit (a fictitious organization used for illustrative purposes only), Fatima Lourdes, will guide you through a number of issues related to human rights and fair housing.

Fatima: Hello. Welcome to DTU, a fair housing discrimination testing unit. At DTU, we receive consumer complaints about housing discrimination and investigate them. I'm so happy you were able to come today. The more people who understand what housing discrimination is, the less prevalent it will be.

Colin (a visiting licensee): Nice to meet you. I'm ready to learn.

Fatima: Great! As a licensee, you touch people in so many ways in their pursuit of housing-through the types of houses you show them, to how you serve them, in both the rental and selling markets.

Colin: I never thought about that!

Fatima: It's true. As a real estate professional, you have a responsibility to know and understand the applicable fair housing and civil rights laws governing your professional services, as well as your personal conduct. Your colleagues, clients, and customers expect competent actions based on comprehensive knowledge.

Colin: Makes sense.

Fatima: Wise and experienced professionals strictly follow fair housing procedures. And keep in mind, as we talk about protected classes, that federal definitions of protected classes expand and change and that both state and local laws may add protected classes.

Colin: So there are protected classes at the federal, state, and local levels?

Fatima: Oh, yes, and they're ever-broadening as inequities are uncovered. Your license may depend on something you learn today.

Colin: Wow!

Fatima: That's no exaggeration. Compliance with fair housing laws is mandatory. As you learn about and review protected classes and fair housing laws, you will become better equipped to act with honesty, competence, and intelligence in serving your clients and customers.

Colin: I really appreciate you taking the time to educate me on this.

Fatima: My pleasure. After our tour, I hope you will join the ranks of fair housing advocates.

Colin: What do you mean? Are you going to hit me up for a donation or make me hold a picket sign or something?

Fatima: Nothing like that! You become a fair housing advocate by being able to recognize and avoid discriminatory behavior and, when it occurs, pointing consumers toward the appropriate agencies where they may receive justice.

Colin: That I can manage. I like that.